



Effective May 13, 2026

NOTICE OF PRIVACY PRACTICES

Your Information. Your Rights. Our Responsibilities.

THIS NOTICE DESCRIBES HOW MEDICAL INFORMATION ABOUT YOU MAY BE USED AND DISCLOSED AND HOW YOU CAN GET ACCESS TO THIS INFORMATION. PLEASE REVIEW IT CAREFULLY.

Your Rights

Subject to some exceptions, You have the right to:

- Get a copy of your paper or electronic medical record
- Ask us to correct or amend your medical record
- Request confidential communication
- Ask us to limit the information we share
- Get a list of those with whom we've shared your Information (Accounting of Disclosures)
- Get a copy of this privacy notice
- Choose someone to act for you
- File a complaint if you believe your privacy rights have been violated

Your Choices

You have some choices in the way that we use and share information as we:

- Tell family and friends about your condition or answer their coverage questions
- Provide disaster relief
- Include you in a hospital directory
- Provide mental health care
- Market our services and sell your information
- Raise funds

Our Uses and Disclosures

We may use and share your information for treatment, payment and healthcare operations, and as we:

- Help with public health and safety issues
- Do research
- Comply with the law
- Respond to organ and tissue donation requests
- Work with a medical examiner or funeral director
- Address workers' compensation, law enforcement, and other government requests
- Respond to lawsuits and legal actions

To the extent that we have your substance use disorder patient records, subject to 42 CFR Part 2, we will not share that information for investigations or legal proceedings against you without (1) your written consent or (2) a court order and a subpoena.

Our promise regarding your medical information

The Contra Costa Health Services Department (Contra Costa Health) documents the care and services you receive in written and electronic records. In this Notice, we will refer to those records as “medical information.” We need this information to provide you with quality health care and services, evaluate benefits and claims, administer health care coverage, measure performance, and fulfill legal and regulatory requirements. We understand that your health and your medical information is personal. We are committed to protecting your medical information and following all state and federal laws related to the protection of your health information.

Your Rights

Your medical information is the property of Contra Costa Health. However, when it comes to your health information, you have certain rights. This section explains your rights and some of our responsibilities to help you.

GET AN ELECTRONIC OR PAPER COPY OF YOUR MEDICAL RECORD

With certain exceptions, you have the right to see and receive copies of your medical information that was used to make decisions about your care, or decisions about your health plan benefits. You can ask to see or get an electronic or paper copy of your medical record and other health information we have about you. We may charge a reasonable, cost-based fee. If you would like to see or receive a copy of your record on paper or electronically, please write to or call the facility where you received care. If you don't know where the record that you want is located, please write to Health Information Management, Contra Costa Regional Medical Center, 2500 Alhambra Avenue, Martinez, CA 94553 or by fax: (925) 431-2517. If we don't have the record you asked for but we know who does, we will tell you who to contact to request it.

We may deny your request to inspect or copy your record in certain very limited circumstances. If you are denied access to your medical information, we will give you instructions about how you can have the denial reviewed. Denial review is available in most cases.

ASK US TO CORRECT YOUR MEDICAL RECORD

You can ask us to correct medical or claims information about you that you think is incorrect or incomplete. We may say “no” to your request, but we'll tell you why in writing within 60 days. Please write to us and tell us what it is that you want added or corrected and why we should make the correction or addition. Submit your request to the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County, 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553. If we deny your request, you have the right to submit an addendum (your written statement not to exceed 250 words) with respect to any item or statement you believe is incomplete or incorrect in your record. If you clearly indicate in writing that you want the addendum to be made part of your medical record, we will attach it to your record and include it when we disclose the part of the record that you believe to be incomplete or incorrect.

REQUEST CONFIDENTIAL COMMUNICATION

You can ask us to contact you in a specific way (for example, home, office, or cell phone) or to send mail to a certain address. To request confidential communications, you must make your request in writing, specify how or where you wish to be contacted, and submit it to the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County at 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553. When we can reasonably and lawfully agree to your request, we will.

ASK US TO LIMIT WHAT WE USE OR SHARE

You can ask us not to use or share certain health information for treatment, payment, or health care operations. We are not required to agree to your request, and we may say “no,” for example, if it could affect your care. Because we strongly believe that this information is needed to appropriately manage the care of our patients and plan members, we rarely grant such a request. If we do agree, we will comply with your request except that we may still share this information if you need emergency treatment. If you pay for a service or health care item out-of-pocket in full, you can ask us not to share that information for the purpose of payment or our operations with your health insurer. We will say “yes” unless the disclosure is required by law or is determined to be necessary for treatment purposes. To request these restrictions, you must make your request in writing to the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County, 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553. In your request, you must tell us (1) what information you want to limit; (2) whether you want to limit our use, disclosure, or both; and (3) to whom you want the limits to apply, for example, disclosures to your spouse or domestic partner.

GET A LIST OF THOSE WITH WHOM WE’VE SHARED INFORMATION

You can ask for an accounting of disclosures, which is a list of the times we’ve shared your health information for six years prior to the date you ask, who we shared it with, and why. We will include all the disclosures except for those about treatment, payment, and health care operations, and certain other disclosures (such as any disclosures you asked us to make). To request an accounting of disclosures, you must submit your request in writing to the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County, 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553. Your request must state the time period to be covered, which may not be longer than six years and may not include dates before April 14, 2003. We’ll provide one accounting a year at no charge, but we may charge a reasonable, cost-based fee if you ask for another one within 12 months.

GET A COPY OF THIS PRIVACY NOTICE

You can ask for a paper copy of this notice at any time, even if you have agreed to receive the notice electronically. One way to obtain a paper copy of this Notice is to ask at the registration area of any Contra Costa Health facility. You may also call Contra Costa Health Plan Member Services at (877) 661- 6230, or the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County at (925) 957-5430. You may also obtain a copy of this Notice of Privacy Practices on our website at: <https://www.cchealth.org/about-contra-costa-health/our-vision-and-mission/policies/your-medical-privacy>

CHOOSE SOMEONE TO ACT FOR YOU

If someone has authority to act as your personal representative (someone has your medical power of attorney or is your legal guardian or conservator) that person can exercise your rights and make choices about your health information. We will take reasonable measures to confirm the person has the authority to make decisions about your medical information privacy before we take any action.

FILE A COMPLAINT IF YOU FEEL YOUR RIGHTS ARE VIOLATED

If you believe we have violated your privacy rights, you may file a complaint with any of the following: Contra Costa Health Plan members can call Member Services at (877) 661-6230. Clients of the Contra Costa Mental Health Plan may call the Office of Quality Assurance at (925) 655-2499. You can also write the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County, 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553, or call our 24-hour Privacy Hotline toll free at (800) 659-4611.

Medi-Cal beneficiaries may file a privacy complaint with the California Department of Health Care Services: Privacy Officer c/o: Office of HIPAA Compliance Department of Health Care Services, P.O. Box 997413, MS 4722, Sacramento, CA 95899-7413 or call (866) 866-0602 or (877) 735-2929 TTY/TTD.

You may file a written complaint with the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Office for Civil Rights by sending a letter to 200 Independence Avenue, S.W., Washington, D.C. 20201. Or you can call (877)-696-6775, or visit: <https://www.hhs.gov/hipaa/filing-a-complaint/index.html> for instructions on how to file a complaint.

We will not retaliate against you for filing a complaint about our privacy practices.

Your Choices

For certain health information, you can tell us your choices about what we share.

IN THE FOLLOWING CASES, YOU HAVE BOTH THE RIGHT AND CHOICE TO TELL US TO:

- Share information with your family, close friends, or others involved in your care or payment for your care
- Share information in a disaster relief situation
- Include your information in a hospital directory

If you are unable to tell us your preference, for example if you are unconscious or lack decision-making capacity, we may go ahead and share your information with a family member or other person involved in your care if we believe it is in your best interest. We may also share your information when needed to lessen a serious and imminent threat to health or safety.

FUNDRAISING:

We may contact you when raising funds for the hospital and its operations through a foundation related to the hospital, but you can tell us not to contact you again. If you do not want the hospital to contact you for fundraising, write the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County at 50 Douglas Drive, #310-E, Martinez, CA 94553. If we have your substance use disorder patient records, subject to 42 CFR part 2, we will give you clear and obvious notice in advance and a choice about whether to receive fundraising communications that use your Part 2 information.

WE WILL NOT SHARE YOUR INFORMATION FOR ANY OF THE FOLLOWING PURPOSES UNLESS YOU GIVE US WRITTEN PERMISSION:

- Marketing purposes
- Sale of your information
- Most sharing of psychotherapy notes

Our Uses and Disclosures

We typically use or share your health information in the following ways:

FOR TREATMENT

We can use your health information and share it with other professionals who are treating you. For example: When doctor treating you for an injury asks another doctor about your overall health condition.

FOR OUR OPERATIONS

We can use and share your health information to run our practice, improve your care, and contact you when necessary. For example: We use health information about you to manage your treatment and services.

FOR PAYMENT (BILL FOR YOUR SERVICES)

We can use and share your health information to bill and get payment from health plans or other entities. For example: We give information about you to your health insurance plan so it will pay for your services. The County Health Plans (including the Contra Costa Health Plan and the self-insured group dental plans and flexible spending health accounts for County employees) may use or disclose medical information about you to determine eligibility for plan benefits, obtain premiums, facilitate payment for the treatment and services you receive from health care providers, determine plan responsibility for benefits, and to coordinate benefits.

BUSINESS ASSOCIATES

We sometimes contract with people and businesses who provide services such as accounting, legal, administrative and billing. These are our business associates. We may disclose your medical information to these business associates so that they can perform the job we have asked them to do. When we do, we require a business associate to sign a contract stating they will safeguard your protected medical information the same way we do.

ELECTRONIC HEALTH INFORMATION EXCHANGE

We participate in an electronic health information exchange (HIE) which allows health care providers to share your medical information that is necessary for your treatment. The information shared is maintained in a secure system and is not released outside of the healthcare setting without your written authorization. You may opt out of sharing your information by contacting Health Information Management at (844) 240-6459 or HIMDROI@cchealth.org

FOR REMINDERS

We may contact you to remind you that you have an appointment, or that you should make an appointment at one of our facilities.

FOR HEALTH-RELATED BENEFITS & SERVICES

We may contact you about benefits or services that we provide.

FOR TREATMENT ALTERNATIVES

We may tell you about or recommend possible treatment options or alternatives that may be of interest to you.

Other Ways We Use or Share Your Health Information

We are allowed or required to share your information in other ways – usually in ways that contribute to the public good, such as public health and research. We have to meet many conditions in the law before we can share your information for these purposes. In all cases, including those listed below, if we have

substance use disorder patient records about you, subject to 42 CFR part 2, we cannot use or share the information in those records in civil, criminal, administrative, or legislative investigations or proceedings against you without (1) your consent or (2) a court order and a subpoena.

HELP WITH PUBLIC HEALTH AND SAFETY ISSUES

We can share health information about you for certain situations including but not limited to:

- Preventing or controlling disease
- Helping with product recalls
- Reporting adverse reactions to medications
- Reporting suspected abuse, neglect, or domestic violence
- Preventing or reducing a serious threat to anyone's health or safety

RESEARCH

Your medical information can be important to the development of greater knowledge in health. Your medical information can generally be used or disclosed for research without your permission if an Institutional Review Board (IRB) approves such use or disclosure. An IRB is a committee that is responsible, under federal law, for reviewing and approving research projects. The IRB is responsible for protecting the safety and welfare of the participants and the confidentiality of medical information.

COMPLY WITH THE LAW

We will share information about you if state or federal laws require it, including with the Department of Health and Human Services if it wants to see that we're complying with federal privacy law.

RESPOND TO ORGAN AND TISSUE DONATION REQUESTS

If you are an organ or tissue donor, we can share health information about you with organ procurement organizations as necessary to facilitate organ and tissue donation and transplantation.

WORK WITH A CORONER, MEDICAL EXAMINER OR FUNERAL DIRECTOR

We can share health information with a coroner, medical examiner, or funeral director when an individual dies, for example to identify a deceased person or determine cause of death.

ADDRESS WORKERS' COMPENSATION AND OTHER GOVERNMENT REQUESTS

We can use or share health information about you:

- For workers' compensation claims
- For law enforcement purposes or with a law enforcement official
- With health oversight agencies for activities authorized by law
- For special government functions such as military, national security, and presidential protective services

LAW ENFORCEMENT REQUESTS

If asked to do so by law enforcement, and as authorized or required by law, we may release medical information:

- To identify or locate a suspect, fugitive, material witness, or missing person
- About a suspected victim of a crime if, under certain limited circumstances, we are unable to obtain the person's agreement
- About a death suspected to be the result of criminal conduct
- About criminal conduct at one of our facilities
- In case of a medical emergency, to report a crime, the location of the crime or victims, or the identity, description, or location of the person who committed the crime

RESPOND TO LAWSUITS AND LEGAL ACTIONS

We can share health information about you in response to a court or administrative order, or in response to a subpoena, discovery request, warrant, summons or other lawful process. We may also use or disclose your medical information, to the extent permitted by law without your consent, to defend a lawsuit.

FOR HEALTH OVERSIGHT ACTIVITIES

As health care providers and health plans, we are subject to oversight by accrediting, licensing, federal, and state agencies. These agencies may conduct audits of our operations and activities, and in that process, they may review your medical information.

INMATES

If you are an inmate of a correctional institution or under the custody of a law enforcement official, we may release medical information about you to the correctional institution for certain purposes, for example, to protect your health or safety or someone else's. Note: Under the federal law that requires us to give you this Notice, inmates do not have the same rights to control their medical information as other individuals.

MULTI-DISCIPLINARY PERSONNEL TEAMS

We may disclose medical information to a multi-disciplinary personnel team relevant to the prevention, identification, management, care coordination or treatment of a child who has been or is at risk of abuse or neglect, and the child's parents, or in the case of elder abuse and neglect.

SPECIAL CATEGORIES OF INFORMATION

In some instances, your medical information may be subject to restrictions that limit or preclude some uses or disclosures described in this Notice. For example, there are special restrictions on the use or disclosure of certain categories of information, such as tests for HIV, treatment for behavioral health conditions or for substance use disorders. In these cases, we will comply with the more restrictive laws, such as the California law restricting disclosures of mental health records that would be permitted by HIPAA. In addition, government health benefit programs, such as Medi-Cal, may also limit the disclosure of beneficiary information for purposes unrelated to the program.

ALL OTHER USES AND DISCLOSURES OF YOUR MEDICAL INFORMATION REQUIRE YOUR PRIOR WRITTEN AUTHORIZATION

Other uses and disclosures of medical information not covered by this Notice or the laws that apply to us will be made only with your written permission. If you provide us permission to use or disclose medical information about you, you may revoke that permission, in writing, at any time. Please note that the revocation will not apply to any authorized use or disclosure of your medical information that took place before we received your revocation. Also, if you gave your authorization to secure a policy of insurance, including health care coverage from us, you may not be permitted to revoke it until the insurer can no longer contest the policy issued to you or a claim under the policy.

Our Responsibilities

We are required by law to maintain the privacy and security of your protected health information. We will let you know promptly if a breach occurs that may have compromised the privacy or security of your information. We must follow the duties and privacy practices described in this notice and give you a copy of it. We will not use or share your information other than as described in this notice unless you tell us we can in writing. If you tell us we can, you may change your mind at any time. Let us know in writing if you change your mind.

For more information see: www.hhs.gov/ocr/privacy/hipaa/understanding/consumers/noticepp.html

Changes to this Notice

We can change the terms of this notice and our privacy practices, and the changes will apply to all information we have about you at the time of the change and any medical information created or received after the change takes effect. Any changes we make must be consistent with state and federal law. We will post a copy of our current Notice in all of the Contra Costa Health facilities and on our website at: <https://www.cchealth.org/about-contra-costa-health/our-vision-and-mission/policies/your-medical-privacy> The effective date of the Notice is found on the top right-hand corner of page one.

Who Will Follow This Notice

This Notice of Privacy Practices applies to all divisions and programs of Contra Costa Health that are required to comply with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1976 (HIPAA) and all employees and members of the workforce, including physicians, nurses and other health professionals and staff that help you to get care or who have access to your medical information, selected staff responsible for payment, operational support and other administrative functions, members of volunteer groups and students who help you get care, self-insured group dental plans and flexible spending health accounts for county employees and our Business Associates. Contra Costa Health includes but is not limited to the Contra Costa Regional Medical Center and Health Centers, Behavioral Health Services Division, mental health clinics, Public Health, Health Housing and Homeless Services, Emergency Medical Services, and the Contra Costa Health Plan. In addition, all the above may share medical information with each other for treatment, payment, or health care operations purposes as described in this Notice.

Questions

If you have any questions about this Notice, please contact the Privacy Office of Contra Costa County at (925) 957-5430. If you have questions related to health information privacy, access the Office for Civil Rights' database under Health Information Privacy at: [Health Information Privacy | HHS.gov](https://www.hhs.gov/health-information-privacy)